

In-Force Customer Service (General)

Standard Operating Procedure

Document Reference	SOP-INS-009
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Owner	Customer Service — Policy Servicing
Approved By	Chief Customer Officer
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All inbound service requests from current Meridian Insurance Group policyholders

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the process for receiving and resolving inbound requests from current policyholders across all channels, including calls, emails, web chat, and portal submissions. It ensures that all policyholder enquiries, account update requests, payment queries, and policy information requests are handled consistently, efficiently, and within defined service level timeframes.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- All inbound policyholder contacts for general account enquiries, policy information, billing queries, and payment processing
- Account updates including address changes, contact detail updates, and payment method changes
- Policyholder requests for policy documents, certificates, and statements

This procedure does NOT cover: claims notifications (SOP-INS-011: P&C; Claims; SOP-INS-007: Medical Claims), complaints requiring formal escalation (SOP-COMP-001), or policy cancellation requests (SOP-INS-011).

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Customer Service Representative (CSR)	Receives and logs all inbound contacts; handles standard enquiries and account updates within authority level; escalates complex or sensitive requests; meets response time and quality SLAs.
Member Care Representative	Handles complex or emotionally sensitive policyholder situations; manages VIP policyholders; coordinates across departments to resolve multi-issue contacts.
Policy Service Representative	Processes formal account changes requiring system updates (e.g., address changes, payment method updates, document reissue); provides back-office support for CSR queue.
Team Leader / Supervisor	Monitors real-time queue performance; handles escalated contacts; approves exceptions outside CSR authority; reviews quality scores.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

Triggered by any inbound policyholder contact via phone, email, web chat, or self-service portal. All contacts must be handled only after successful identity verification.

5. Process Steps

5.1 Contact Receipt and Identity Verification

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
1	Inbound contact received via phone, email, chat, or portal	CSR / ACD System	Contact logged in CRM; channel and timestamp recorded

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
2	Identity verification	CSR	Minimum 3-point verification: policy number, date of birth, and postcode/registered email. Contact on hold until verification passed.
3	Contact purpose identified and categorised	CSR	Contact type coded in CRM (enquiry, account update, payment, document request, complaint, etc.)
4	Policy record retrieved and reviewed	CSR / PAS	Policy status, payment standing, and recent interaction history reviewed before engaging

5.2 Request Handling

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
5	Standard enquiry resolved at first contact	CSR	Policy information, billing details, payment dates, and coverage summaries provided within CSR authority
6	Account update processed (address, payment, contacts)	CSR / Policy Service Rep	Update processed in PAS; confirmation sent to policyholder via email; change noted in CRM
7	Document request fulfilled	CSR / PAS (auto)	Certificate of insurance, policy schedule, or payment receipt regenerated and emailed within 24 hours
8	Payment received or payment arrangement set up	CSR	Payment processed via IVR or agent-assisted; arrangement approved per SOP-INS-003 authority matrix
9	Complex or sensitive contact escalated to Member Care	CSR / Member Care Rep	Escalation logged in CRM; Member Care Rep contacts policyholder within 2 hours if unable to resolve immediately

5.3 Contact Closure and Quality

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
10	Resolution confirmed with policyholder	CSR	Summary of actions taken communicated verbally or in writing
11	Contact record closed and coded in CRM	CSR	Resolution code, handle time, and CSAT prompt recorded; follow-up task set if action is pending

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
12	Post-interaction survey sent (phone and email channels)	CRM (auto)	CSAT survey dispatched; responses captured for quality reporting

6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Failed Identity Verification

- After 2 failed verification attempts, CSR politely terminates contact and advises policyholder to call back with correct information
- Third failed attempt within 24 hours triggers a security flag on the policy record; Team Leader notified
- No account information may be provided to an unverified caller under any circumstances

6.2 Formal Complaint Identified

- CSR identifies complaint language ('unhappy', 'unacceptable', 'want to complain') and escalates immediately to Member Care
- Formal complaint logged in the Complaints Register within 30 minutes per SOP-COMP-001
- CSR must not attempt to resolve formal complaints without Member Care or Supervisor involvement

6.3 Policyholder Reports Potential Fraud or Identity Theft

- CSR immediately transfers to Member Care and simultaneously flags policy in PAS as 'Security Hold'
- Fraud team notified within 1 hour; no account changes processed until fraud review is complete

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access
CRM (Salesforce)	Contact logging, case management, queue management, CSAT tracking	All CSR roles
Policy Administration System (PAS)	Policy record, account updates, document generation	CSR, Policy Service Rep
ACD / IVR System (NICE CXone)	Call routing, IVR payment processing, call recording	CSR, Team Leader
Web Chat Platform	Real-time chat handling, transcript archiving	CSR
Self-Service Portal	Policyholder self-service for standard changes and document downloads	Policyholders

8. Key Performance Indicators

- First Contact Resolution (FCR) rate: Minimum 78% of contacts fully resolved on first interaction
- Average Handle Time (AHT): Target below 5 minutes for standard enquiries
- Phone answer rate within 30 seconds: Minimum 80% during core hours
- Email response SLA: 100% of emails acknowledged within 4 business hours; resolved within 2 business days
- CSAT score: Minimum 4.2 out of 5.0 on post-contact survey

- Identity verification compliance: Zero contacts served without passing 3-point verification

9. Related Documents

- SOP-COMP-001: Complaints Handling
- SOP-INS-003: Bill Collection (Insurance Premiums)
- SOP-INS-010: Policy Endorsement and Mid-Term Adjustment
- POL-PRIV-001: Customer Data Privacy and Security Policy

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	01 Jan 2020	W. Chong, Customer Service	Initial release
2.0	10 Mar 2022	W. Chong, Customer Service	Added web chat channel; updated identity verification to 3-point
2.1	15 Aug 2023	L. Adebayo, CS Ops	Integrated NICE CXone; added fraud exception handling
3.0	01 Jan 2025	L. Adebayo, CS Ops	Full rewrite aligned to Salesforce CRM migration; new FCR and AHT KPI baselines